# raimundo p. solar

# portfolio 2024

**Shapes of the Miombo** (2024)
Web video game — p5.js

Shapes of the Miombo is based on real encounter probabilities derived from my own fieldwork data collection, reflecting the reality of research in mixed-use landscapes, where humans and wildlife share the same territories. This depiction provides a more accurate representation of the African continent's ecological reality, in contrast to national parks where local communities have been excluded.



The game offers a subtle yet immersive experience, designed to transport players into the Miombo woodlands, one of Africa's vast and ecologically rich ecosystems. Inspired by my own field observations and shaped by my reflections on conservation narratives and digital storytelling, the objective is to challenge traditional perceptions of wildlife encounters. One of the core concepts of the game is to question visibility in conservation. In media and wildlife tourism, nature is often portrayed as abundant and easily observable, reinforcing an illusion of accessibility.





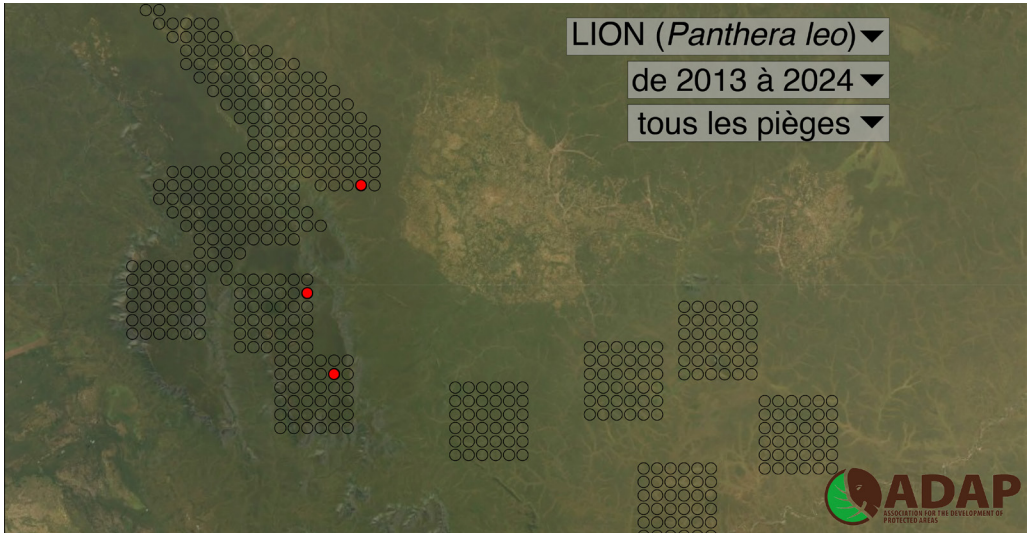
The player embarks on a journey through the Miombo woodlands in a blue Toyota, searching for a rare species. However, much like in the field, this search is marked by long stretches of time without sightings, with only indirect traces—shadows, tree stumps, or imagined figures—hinting at the presence of wildlife. Occasionally, the player encounters real animals, but they appear elusive and cryptic, requiring a keen eye to detect. The most probable encounters are giraffes and yellow baboons, two of the most abundant and visible species. This pattern invites the player to reflect: Why do we repeatedly see these animals? Is it due to their behaviour? Is it because they are not hunted, which in turn has shaped their way of living compared to other species?



The experience is designed to be slow and reflective, echoing time spent in the nature, where patience and awareness are essential to discovering signs of life.

Design Concept at https://ra-solar.github.io/safari-r/

**Grids of Life** (2024)
Interactive online map — concept




This map invites exploration of a landscape of hidden presences, where the forest reveals itself not through direct encounters, but through the snapshots captured by camera traps.



Each point represents a camera trap placed in the field according to a systematic grid. By selecting a point, visitors uncover details about the surrounding environment, view sequential images captured over time, and witness how species—often elusive—move through shared human-wildlife spaces.

Analytical maps derived from the data further guide visitors through predictive models of species distributions, offering insight into how systematic research is transformed into knowledge that informs real conservation decisions.



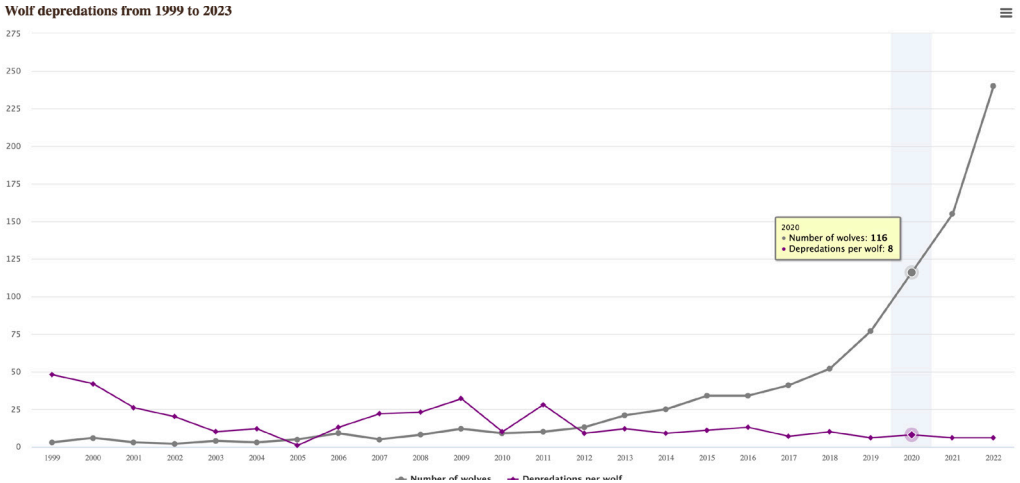


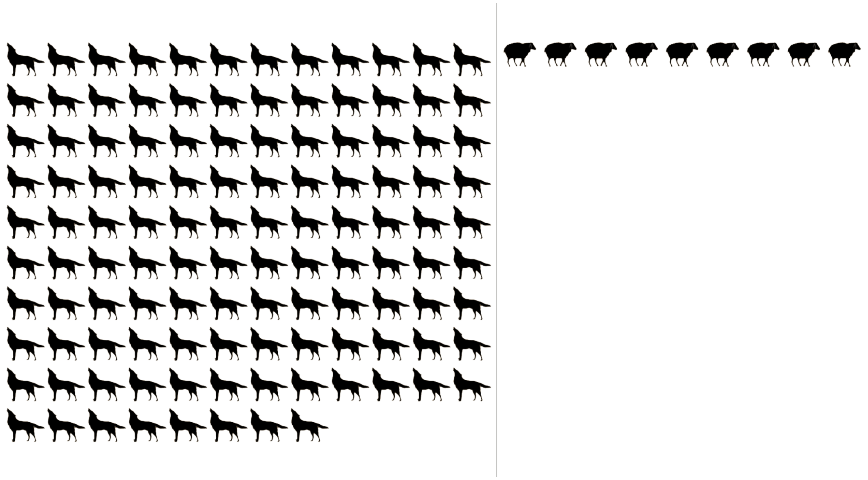
The contrast between detailed and under-represented species will reflect relative abundance—merging content and form to visually emphasize rarity. Representation ideas :

- Species images could be pixelated according to the number of sightings (e.g., if only 20 photos of wild dogs exist, each image would be composed of 20 pixels). (See: Yoshiyuki Mikami, 2008)
- Alternatively, photo mosaics could be created from all available images of a species, showing presence through accumulation.

**Predation in Proportions** (2024)
Interactive graphs — R + Processing

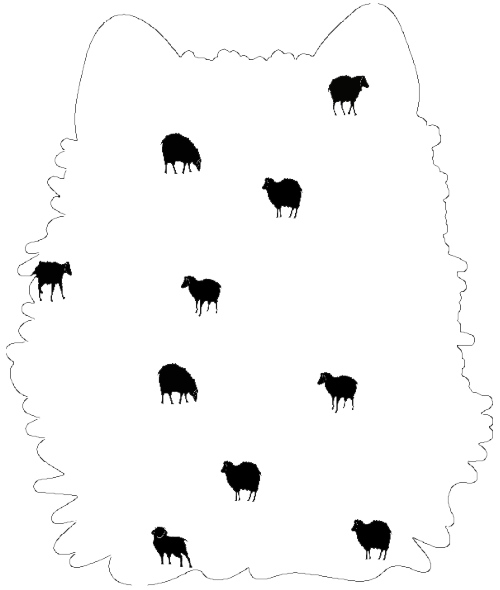
In Switzerland, wolf depredation on livestock is a topic of intense debate. As the wolf population expands, so too does the total number of sheep killed—feeding the perception that the situation is spiralling out of control. But a closer look reveals a more nuanced story: while the number of wolves has increased, the number of sheep killed per wolf has steadily declined. In other words, each individual wolf is responsible for fewer attacks, yet this subtle trend often goes unnoticed in traditional graphs and statistics.



Rather than abstract lines, this project invites users to “feel” the changing proportions. Through an interactive slider, each year’s data is revealed as shapes representing both the total wolf population and the corresponding number of sheep killed per wolf. In this way, raw figures are transformed into a tangible, visual experience.

By visually reframing the narrative, the tests aim to highlight the importance of perspective in conversations about human-wildlife coexistence.



Concept tests at https://kora-ch.github.io/wolf-depr-en/